



Bowling into Controversy

CHANDIGARH Even as Team India plays ball amidst alleged racist remarks in Australia, former Indian cricket captain Bishan Singh Bedi has bowled himself into a controversy on the home pitch. The legendary off-spinner played demolition man at his ancestral property in Amritsar on February 25 to get it evicted from long-time tenant Anil Dilawari. His action invited a mouthful of public ire and a police probe for the

alleged violation of tenancy laws.

Bedi has for long been staking claim on the 1,000-sq yard prime property which was rented out 30 years ago by his sister Anupam Sodhi, now deceased. Dilawari claims Bedi has been illegally pressuring him to vacate the property which stood in Sodhi's name, a claim that Bedi disputes insisting that it was owned by his father late Gian Singh Bedi. A few months

HOUSE THAT: Bedi

ago, Bedi had got a notice issued by the municipal corporation declaring the rented property unfit for living. But this eviction tactic didn't work as the local corporation councilor supported Dilawari.

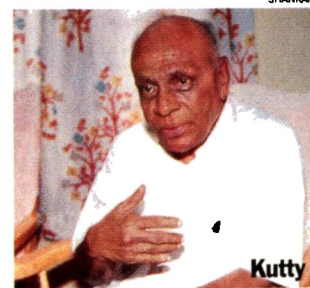
Apparently frustrated, Bedi decided to take the matter in his own hands and demolished the rented portion. While the former cricketer insists his action is lawful as he wants his ancestral property back so that he could settle down in Amritsar for promoting cricket, the tenant has cried foul, claiming that the demolition has damaged his industrial machinery worth Rs 20 lakh. He is in the business of making spare parts for textile industries.

Bedi claims Dilawari has been illegally occupying a part of the property and that he had not paid the rent for the past 35 years and had illegally sub-let a portion of the house. This time round, it seems Bedi has bowled himself a googly.

by Ramesh Vinayak

Minority Report

THIRUVANANTHAPURAM The Paloli Committee's recommendations on how to implement the Sachar Committee report for the uplift of the Muslims have led to a major row between the Government and Muslim organisations on one side and BJP and high-caste Hindu groups on the other. The state government-appointed Paloli Committee is headed by local Administration Minister



Paloli Mohammed Kutty. BJP claims that the report is nothing but an exercise to appease the Muslim community in Kerala, which is not backward enough to merit concessions and privileges.

However, the row has come as a breather for the LDF Government in the state as it has taken the attention away from the issue of minorities' control over private education institutions. The issue has also divided the alliance between Christians and upper caste Hindu groups with the former expressing displeasure at the latter's opposition to the committee. The committee has recommended job quotas in private sector and judiciary, new educational institutions in backward minority areas and scholarships for Muslim girl students, among others.

by M.G. Radhakrishnan

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